Text 1

第 1 段

A history of long and effortless success can be a dreadful handicap, but, if properly handled, it may become a driving force. When the United States entered just such a glowing period after the end of the Second World War, it had a market eight times larger than any competitor, giving its industries unparalleled economies of scale. Its scientists were the world's best; its workers the most skilled. America and Americans were prosperous beyond the dreams of the Europeans and Asians whose economies the war had destroyed.

直译：长期而轻而易举的成功经历可能成为一种可怕的障碍，但如果处理得当，也可能成为推动力。第二次世界大战结束后，美国进入了这样一个辉煌时期，其市场比任何竞争者的市场大八倍，从而使本国工业具有无与伦比的规模经济优势。它的科学家是世界上最优秀的，工人是技术最娴熟的。美国及美国人的富裕程度，超出了那些经济被战争摧毁的欧洲人和亚洲人的梦想。

第 2 段

It was inevitable that this primacy should have narrowed as other countries grew richer. Just as inevitably, the retreat from predominance proved painful. By the mid-1980s Americans had found themselves at a loss over their fading industrial competitiveness. Some huge American industries, such as consumer electronics, had shrunk or vanished in the face of foreign competition. By 1987 there was only one American television maker left, Zenith. (Now there is none: Zenith was bought by South Korea's LG Electronics in July.) Foreign-made cars and textiles were sweeping into the domestic market. America's machine-tool industry was on the ropes. For a while it looked as though the making of semiconductors, which America had invented and which sat at the heart of the new computer age, was going to be the next casualty.

直译：随着其他国家更加富裕，这种领先地位必然会缩小。同样不可避免的是，从优势地位退却被证明是痛苦的。到 20 世纪 80 年代中期，美国人发现自己对不断减弱的工业竞争力感到茫然无措。一些庞大的美国工业部门，如消费电子业，在外国竞争面前已经萎缩或消失。到 1987 年，美国只剩下一家电视机制造商 ——Zenith（天顶公司）。（现在一家也没有了：Zenith 在 7 月被韩国 LG 电子公司收购。）外国制造的汽车和纺织品正涌入国内市场。美国机床工业已濒临困境。一度看来，半导体制造业似乎将成为下一个受害者；半导体由美国发明，并处于新计算机时代的核心。

第 3 段

All of this caused a crisis of confidence. Americans stopped taking prosperity for granted. They began to believe that their way of doing business was failing, and that their incomes would therefore shortly begin to fall as well. The mid-1980s brought one inquiry after another into the causes of America's industrial decline. Their sometimes sensational findings were filled with warnings about the growing competition from overseas.

直译：这一切引发了信心危机。美国人不再把繁荣视为理所当然。他们开始相信，自己的经营方式正在失效，因此收入也很快会开始下降。20 世纪 80 年代中期，关于美国工业衰退原因的调查接连出现。这些有时耸人听闻的调查结果，充满了对海外竞争不断加剧的警告。

第 4 段

How things have changed! In 1995 the United States can look back on five years of solid growth while Japan has been struggling. Few Americans attribute this solely to such obvious causes as a devalued dollar or the turning of the business cycle. Self-doubt has yielded to blind pride. “American industry has changed its structure, has gone on a diet, has learnt to be more quick-witted,” according to Richard Cavanaugh, executive dean of Harvard’s Kennedy School of Government. “It makes me proud to be an American just to see how our businesses are improving their productivity,” says Stephen Moore of the Cato Institute, a think-tank in Washington, DC. And William Sahlman of the Harvard Business School believes that people will look back on this period as “a golden age of business management in the United States.”

直译：情况发生了多么大的变化！在 1995 年，美国可以回顾过去五年的稳健增长，而日本却一直在艰难挣扎。很少有美国人把这一切仅仅归因于美元贬值或经济周期转变等明显原因。自我怀疑已让位于盲目自豪。哈佛大学肯尼迪政府学院执行院长理查德·卡瓦诺说：“美国工业改变了结构，进行了瘦身，并学会了更机敏地应对。”华盛顿智库卡托研究所的斯蒂芬·穆尔说：“仅仅看到我们的企业正在提高生产率，就让我为身为美国人而自豪。”哈佛商学院的威廉·萨尔曼则认为，人们回顾这一时期时，会把它看作“美国企业管理的黄金时代”。

篇章简析

主旨：美国工业从战后优势，经竞争冲击与信心危机，走向重组后的复苏。作者以 blind pride 提醒读者警惕盲目自满。首句 if properly handled 省略主语及 be；第 2 段 which ... and which ... 两个从句共同修饰 semiconductors。

Text 2

第 1 段

Being a man has always been dangerous. There are about 105 males born for every 100 females, but this ratio drops to near balance at the age of maturity, and among 70-year-olds there are twice as many women as men. But the great universal of male mortality is being changed. Now, boy babies survive almost as well as girls do. This means that, for the first time, there will be an excess of boys in those crucial years when they are searching for a mate. More important, another chance for natural selection has been removed. Fifty years ago, the chance of a baby (particularly a boy baby) surviving depended on its weight. A kilogram too light or too heavy meant almost certain death. Today it makes almost no difference. Since much of the variation is due to genes, one more agent of evolution has gone.

直译：身为男性一直是危险的。每出生 100 名女婴，大约就有 105 名男婴，但这一比例在成年时降至接近平衡；在 70 岁的人群中，女性人数是男性的两倍。不过，男性死亡率较高这一普遍规律正在改变。如今，男婴的存活情况几乎与女婴一样好。这意味着，男孩们在寻找伴侣的那些关键年龄段中，人数将首次出现过剩。更重要的是，自然选择的又一次机会已被消除。五十年前，婴儿 —— 尤其是男婴 —— 的存活机会取决于体重。轻一千克或重一千克，几乎都意味着必死无疑。今天，这几乎没有影响。由于这种差异在很大程度上来自基因，进化的又一个作用因素消失了。

第 2 段

There is another way to commit evolutionary suicide: stay alive, but have fewer children. Few people are as fertile as in the past. Except in some religious communities, very few women have 15 children. Nowadays the number of births, like the age of death, has become average. Most of us have roughly the same number of offspring. Again, differences between people and the opportunity for natural selection to take advantage of it have diminished. India shows what is happening. The country offers wealth for a few in the great cities and poverty for the remaining tribal peoples. The grand mediocrity of today—everyone being the same in survival and number of offspring—means that natural selection has lost 80% of its power in upper-middle-class India compared to the tribes.

直译：还有另一种实施“进化自杀”的方式：活着，但少生孩子。很少有人像过去那样多育。除了一些宗教群体，几乎没有妇女生 15 个孩子。如今，生育数量同死亡年龄一样，已趋于平均。我们大多数人的后代数量大致相同。人与人之间的差异，以及自然选择利用这种差异的机会，再一次减少了。印度显示了正在发生的情况。这个国家给大城市中的少数人带来财富，而其余部落居民仍处于贫困之中。今天的这种大范围平均化 —— 每个人的存活情况和后代数量都一样 —— 意味着，与部落群体相比，在印度中上层阶级中，自然选择已经丧失了 80% 的作用。

第 3 段

For us, this means that evolution is over; the biological Utopia has arrived. Strangely, it has involved little physical change. No other species fills so many places in nature. But in the past 100,000 years—even the past 100 years—our lives have been transformed but our bodies have not. We did not evolve, because machines and society did it for us. Darwin had a phrase to describe those ignorant of evolution: they "look at an organic being as a savage looks at a ship, as at something wholly beyond his comprehension." No doubt we will remember a 20th century way of life beyond comprehension for its ugliness. But however amazed our descendants may be at how far from Utopia we were, they will look just like us.

直译：对我们来说，这意味着进化结束了；生物学上的乌托邦已经到来。奇怪的是，它几乎没有涉及身体变化。没有其他物种在自然界占据如此多的位置。但在过去十万年中，甚至在过去一百年中，我们的生活已经改变，身体却没有。我们没有进化，因为机器和社会替我们完成了这种改变。达尔文曾用一句话描述那些不了解进化的人：他们 " 看待有机生物，就像一个未开化的人看待船舶，把它看作完全超出自己理解力的东西 "。毫无疑问，我们会记得 20 世纪的生活方式，因为它的丑陋而令人无法理解。但无论我们的后代会多么惊讶于我们离乌托邦竟如此遥远，他们看上去仍会与我们一模一样。

篇章简析

主旨：作者借婴儿存活与生育差异缩小，论述现代条件削弱自然选择的作用。evolution is over 是文中作者的强判断，应作为作者观点理解，不作为本讲义确认的科学定论。末句 however amazed ... may be 表让步，主句是 they will look just like us。

Text 3

第 1 段

When a new movement in art attains a certain fashion, it is advisable to find out what its advocates are aiming at, for, however farfetched and unreasonable their principles may seem today, it is possible that in years to come they may be regarded as normal. With regard to Futurist poetry, however, the case is rather difficult, for whatever Futurist poetry may be—even admitting that the theory on which it is based may be right—it can hardly be classed as Literature.

直译：当艺术上的一种新运动达到一定的流行程度时，弄清它的提倡者意欲何为，是明智的；因为无论其原则在今天显得多么牵强和不合理，未来都有可能被视为正常。不过，就未来主义诗歌而言，情况相当棘手，因为无论未来主义诗歌究竟是什么，即使承认它所依据的理论可能正确，也很难把它归入文学。

第 2 段

This, in brief, is what the Futurist says: for a century past, conditions of life have been continually speeding up, till now we live in a world of noise and violence and speed. Consequently, our feelings, thoughts and emotions have undergone a corresponding change.

直译：简言之，未来主义者是这样说的：一百年来，生活状况一直在加速，以至于如今我们生活在一个充满噪声、暴力和速度的世界。因此，我们的感受、思想和情绪也经历了相应的变化。

第 3 段

This speeding up of life, says the Futurist, requires a new form of expression. We must speed up our literature too, if we want to interpret modern stress. We must pour out a large stream of essential words, unhampered by stops, or qualifying adjectives, or finite verbs. Instead of describing sounds we must make up words that imitate them; we must use many sizes of type and different colored inks on the same page, and shorten or lengthen words at will.

直译：未来主义者说，生活的这种加速需要一种新的表达形式。如果想表现现代生活的压力，我们也必须加快文学的速度。我们必须倾泻出大量本质性的词语，不受标点、限定性形容词或限定动词的阻碍。我们必须创造模仿声音的词语，而不是描述声音；必须在同一页上使用多种字号和不同颜色的墨水，并随意缩短或加长词语。

第 4 段

Certainly their descriptions of battles are confused. But it is a little upsetting to read in the explanatory notes that a certain line describes a fight between a Turkish and a Bulgarian officer on a bridge off which they both fall into the river and then to find that the line consists of the noise of their falling and the weights of the officers: “Pluff! Pluff! A hundred and eighty-five kilograms.”

直译：他们对战斗的描写当然是混乱的。但读到注释说，某一行诗描述了一名土耳其军官和一名保加利亚军官在桥上搏斗，两人都从桥上掉进河里，而随后却发现，这一行诗只包含他们落水的声音及其体重，确实有些令人不快：“扑通！扑通！一百八十五千克。”

第 5 段

This, though it fulfills the laws and requirements of Futurist poetry, can hardly be classed as Literature. All the same, no thinking man can refuse to accept their first proposition: that a great change in our emotional life calls for a change of expression. The whole question is really this: have we essentially changed?

直译：尽管这符合未来主义诗歌的法则和要求，却很难被归入文学。不过，任何有思考能力的人都不能拒绝接受他们的第一个命题：情感生活的巨大变化，要求表达方式发生变化。整个问题实际上是：我们是否发生了本质变化？

篇章简析

主旨：作者承认情感变化可能要求表达革新，但质疑未来主义诗歌的极端形式及其前提。第 1 段 however ... 与 whatever ... 均含让步；末段接受 first proposition，不等于接受全部诗学主张。finite verbs 指有时态、人称等限定形式的动词。

Text 4

第 1 段

Aimlessness has hardly been typical of the postwar Japan whose productivity and social harmony are the envy of the United States and Europe. But increasingly the Japanese are seeing a decline of the traditional work-moral values. Ten years ago young people were hardworking and saw their jobs as their primary reason for being, but now Japan has largely fulfilled its economic needs, and young people don't know where they should go next.

直译：漫无目标几乎从来不是战后日本的典型特征；日本的生产率与社会和谐曾令美国和欧洲羡慕。但日本人越来越多地看到，传统的工作道德价值观正在衰退。十年前，年轻人勤奋工作，把工作视为自己存在的首要理由；然而，如今日本大体上已满足经济需求，年轻人不知道下一步该走向哪里。

第 2 段

The coming of age of the postwar baby boom and an entry of women into the male-dominated job market have limited the opportunities of teen-agers who are already questioning the heavy personal sacrifices involved in climbing Japan's rigid social ladder to good schools and jobs. In a recent survey, it was found that only 24.5 percent of Japanese students were fully satisfied with school life, compared with 67.2 percent of students in the United States. In addition, far more Japanese workers expressed dissatisfaction with their jobs than did their counterparts in the 10 other countries surveyed.

直译：战后婴儿潮一代成年，以及女性进入男性主导的就业市场，限制了青少年的机会；这些青少年本就已经在质疑，为沿着日本僵化的社会阶梯攀登、进入好学校和获得好工作而付出的沉重个人牺牲。在最近一项调查中，只有 24.5% 的日本学生对学校生活完全满意，而美国学生的比例为 67.2%。此外，与受调查的其他十个国家的劳动者相比，对工作表示不满的日本劳动者要多得多。

第 3 段

While often praised by foreigners for its emphasis on the basics, Japanese education tends to stress test taking and mechanical learning over creativity and self-expression. "Those things that do not show up in the test scores—personality, ability, courage or humanity—are completely ignored," says Toshiki Kaifu, chairman of the ruling Liberal Democratic Party's education committee. "Frustration against this kind of thing leads kids to drop out and run wild." Last year Japan experienced 2,125 incidents of school violence, including 929 assaults on teachers. Amid the outcry, many conservative leaders are seeking a return to the prewar emphasis on moral education. Last year Mitsuo Setoyama, who was then education minister, raised eyebrows when he argued that liberal reforms introduced by the American occupation authorities after World War II had weakened the "Japanese morality of respect for parents."

直译：尽管日本教育因重视基础而经常受到外国人称赞，它却往往把应试和机械学习置于创造力和自我表达之上。执政的自由民主党教育委员会主席海部俊树说："那些无法在考试分数中体现的东西——个性、能力、勇气或人性——全被忽视了。对这类事情的挫败感，使孩子们辍学并变得放纵。"去年，日本发生了 2125 起校园暴力事件，其中包括 929 起袭击教师事件。在一片强烈抗议声中，许多保守派领导人寻求恢复战前对道德教育的重视。去年，时任教育部长濑户山三男声称，二战后美国占领当局推行的自由化改革削弱了"日本人尊重父母的道德观"，引起人们惊讶和质疑。

第 4 段

But that may have more to do with Japanese life-styles. “In Japan,” says educator Yoko Muro, “it’s never a question of whether you enjoy your job and your life, but only how much you can endure.” With economic growth has come centralization; fully 76 percent of Japan’s 119 million citizens live in cities where community and the extended family have been abandoned in favor of isolated, two-generation households. Urban Japanese have long endured lengthy commutes (travels to and from work) and crowded living conditions, but as the old group and family values weaken, the discomfort is beginning to tell. In the past decade, the Japanese divorce rate, while still well below that of the United States, has increased by more than 50 percent, and suicides have increased by nearly one-quarter.

直译：但这可能更多地与日本人的生活方式有关。教育家室洋子说：“在日本，问题从来不是你是否喜欢自己的工作和生活，而只是你能忍受多少。”随着经济增长，人口集中也随之而来；日本 1.19 亿公民中，足足 76% 居住在城市，那里的人们抛弃了社区联系和大家庭，转而组成彼此隔离的两代人小家庭。城市中的日本人长期忍受漫长通勤和拥挤的居住条件，但随着旧有群体与家庭价值观减弱，这种不适开始显出影响。在过去十年中，日本离婚率虽然仍远低于美国，却已增长 50% 以上，自杀人数也增加了近四分之一。

篇章简析

主旨：日本年轻人的失落与工作价值观变化，和教育、就业及城市生活压力相关。作者在末段用 But that may have more to do with ... 转向生活方式解释。With economic growth has come centralization 为倒装；第 3 段引述保守派归因，不应当作作者结论。

整理说明：依据所附年度试卷提取 Text 1–Text 4；每段英文后接中文直译。已修复明显断词、粘连、错字和标点损坏。文中数据、事件及观点均置于原文章的历史语境中理解。篇章简析为本次整理所加。